

GetTheFlockOuttaHere.org Testimony

Easton, MD Town Council

Norman Bauer - GetTheFlockOuttaHere.org - Director

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Good evening, Mayor Cook, Council President, and members of the Town Council.

My name is Norman Bauer. I live at 9109 Honeysuckle Drive in Easton, and I am the director of GetTheFlockOuttaHere.org.

I am here to request that a member of this Council introduce, and that the Council adopt, the automated vehicle surveillance ordinance already delivered to each of you.

The current Flock system does not begin with a particular suspect. It records every vehicle within view, reads its plate, associates it with a time and location, and places that observation into a searchable database. Innocent drivers are not incidentally caught in the system. Recording them is how the system operates.

Its location at Lowe's does not place it beyond the Town's authority. Section 18-17 of Easton's Code already prohibits retailers from providing single-use disposable plastic bags at the point of sale. The Town plainly regulates and prohibits business activities on private property when they affect the public.

These cameras transform ordinary travel into searchable surveillance data without individualized suspicion, a warrant, public debate, or the consent of the people being recorded.

In 1984, Congressman and physician Dr. Ron Paul called computer surveillance "a disgusting procedure for a professed free society." The technology is more powerful now, but the principle has not changed.

We are not asking for another study, a retention policy, or a weaker substitute.

The Town has a duty to end this surveillance.

We humbly ask to introduce the ordinance. Adopt it. Remove the cameras.

Thank you.